

A COMPOSITIONAL ACCOUNT OF MOTIFS, MECHANISMS, AND DYNAMICS IN BIOCHEMICAL REGULATORY NETWORKS.

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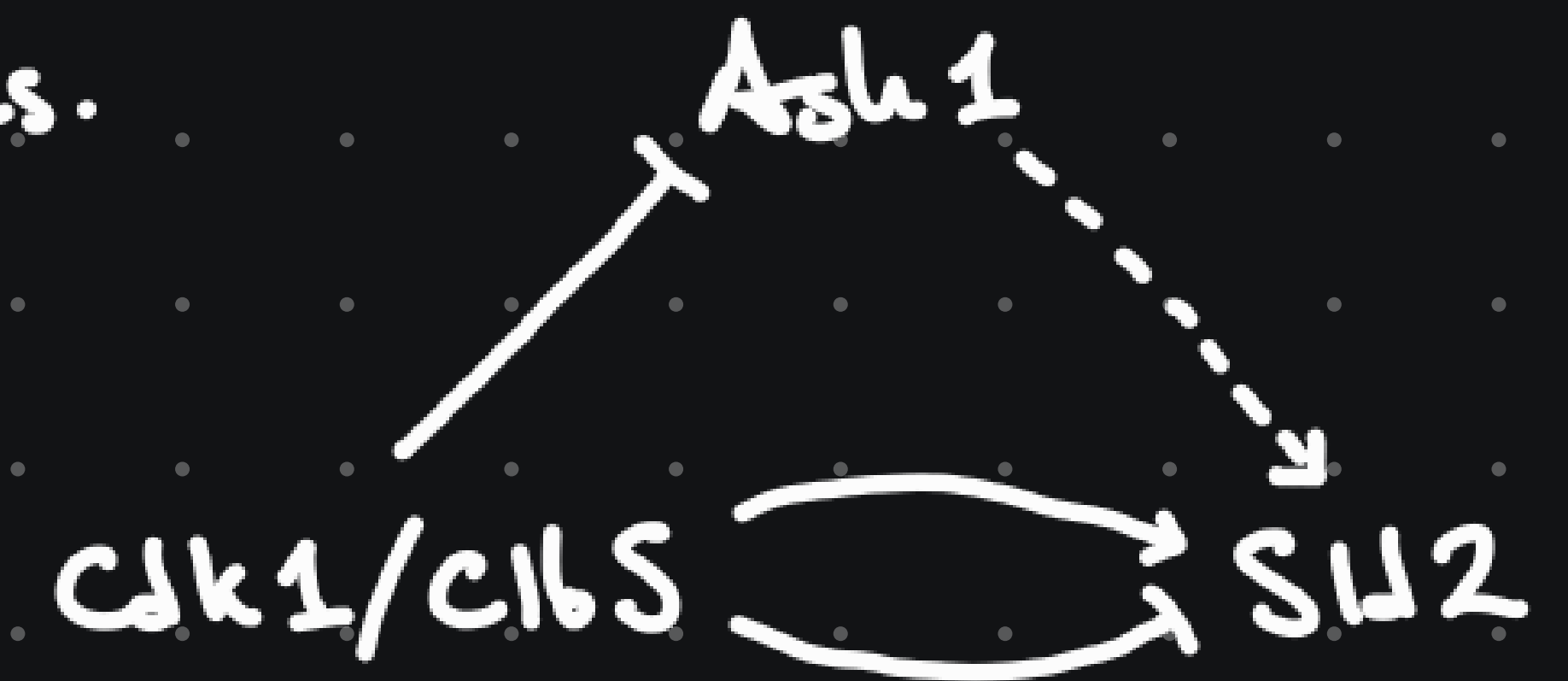
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REGULATORY NETWORKS AND MOTIFS

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A regulatory network conveys interactions between molecules.

- ★ Abundant in the literature.
- ★ Idealized and simplified model.
- ★ Imprecise treatment.



A motif is a simple recurring functionally meaningful pattern of regulatory networks.

Goal: Rigorous working definitions encoding functional interactions.

THE PRINCIPLE OF COMPOSITIONALITY

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The meaning of a complex expression is determined by the combination of its constituents.

Definition: A regulatory network is a signed graph Σ .

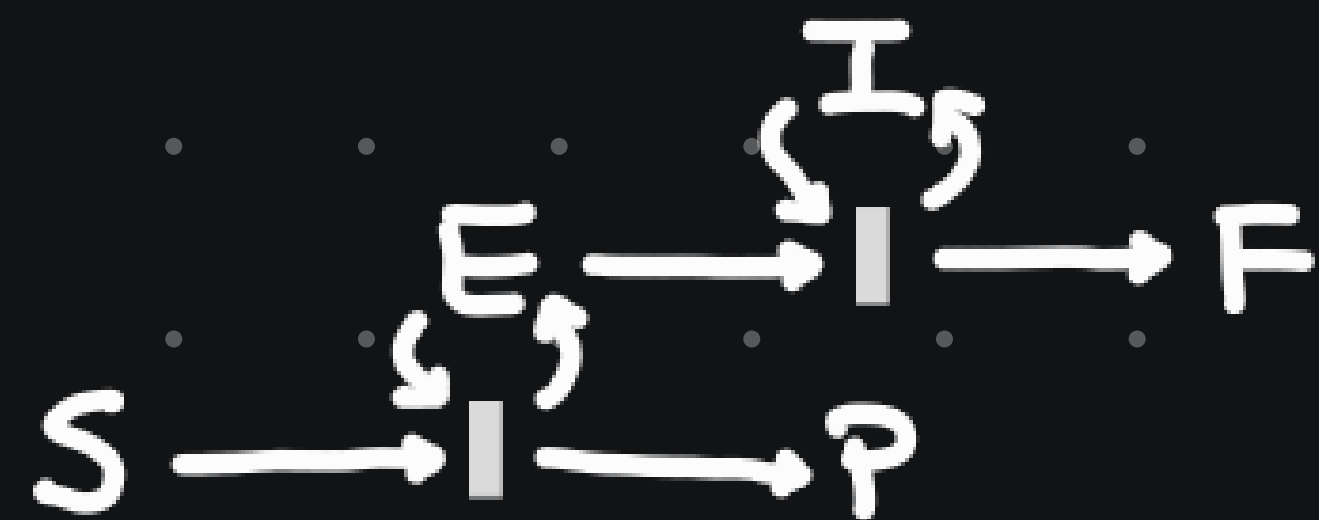
An instance of motif A in Σ is a monic signed functor $\text{Path}(A) \rightarrow \text{Path}(\Sigma)$.

Example: Unifying incoherent feedforward loops: $\{x \overset{+}{\curvearrowright} y\} \rightarrow \{x \rightarrow y \rightarrow z\}$.

We model mechanisms using Petri net with signed links.

Example: $I \rightarrow P$

X



DYNAMICS AND LOTKA-VOLTERRA

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We model dynamics using Lotka-Volterra, a generic model for entities that "regulate" each other.

★ Inspired but completely different from the Law of mass action on Petri nets.

Theorem: There exist functors giving the vector fields of Lotka-Volterra:

$LV: \text{FinGraph} \longrightarrow \text{Para}(\text{Dynam})$ and $LV: \text{FinSgnGraph} \longrightarrow \text{Para}(\text{Dynam}_+)$.

Example:

FinSgnGraph
 $\downarrow LV$
 $\text{Para}(\text{Dynam}_+)$

$A \quad B$
 $\downarrow LV$

$$\begin{cases} v_A(x; p) = -p_A x_A \\ v_B(x; p) = -p_B x_B \end{cases}$$

$\xrightarrow{\quad \tau \quad}$

$A \rightleftarrows B$
 $\downarrow LV$

$$\xrightarrow{LV(\tau)} \begin{cases} v_A(x; p, \beta) = -p_A x_A - \beta_{\rightarrow} x_A x_B \\ v_B(x; p, \beta) = -p_B x_B + \beta_{\rightarrow} x_A x_B \end{cases}$$

Thank you!